

Hayden Smith

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University – Tepper School of Business

Pittsburgh, PA

B.S. in Business Administration, Finance Concentration; Additional Major in Statistics

May 2029

- **GPA:** 3.9/4.0; Dean's List (All Semesters) | **ACT:** 35/36
- **Awards:** National Merit Finalist, AICE Diploma with Merit, High School Valedictorian, High School Football Scholar Athlete
- **Relevant Coursework:** Finance, Accounting, Probability & Statistics for Business, Macroeconomics, Microeconomics, Business Computing, Multivariable Calculus, Data Science, AI & Competitive Advantage, Organizational Behavior, Business Ethics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lockwood Distilling Company

Dallas, TX

Lead Front of House Support

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Served as lead front-of-house support across 5+ areas, including serving, hosting, bussing, bar backing, and food running, requiring constant role flexibility adapting quickly to the demands of each position through intense nighttime restaurant shifts
- Supported 250+ guests per shift while maintaining efficient table turnover, accurate orders, and timely delivery, managed and assisted 14 employees while coordinating between front and back of house to maintain smooth and efficient restaurant operations

Lot 17

Pittsburgh, PA

Sous Chef

Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

- Coordinated and executed 200+ orders every day with an emphasis on accuracy, quality, and efficiency, balancing speed and customer satisfaction to meet expectations while maintaining a fast-paced kitchen environment during high-volume shifts
- Improved kitchen efficiency by reducing average food turnaround time by 17% from order placed to food plated, managed inventory and portioning of daily ingredients with the head chef to maintain adequate stock and minimize unnecessary waste

Hello Sweetz (Candy Shop)

Tarpon Springs, FL

Sales Associate and Inventory Coordinator

Feb 2022 – Aug 2025

- Engaged with 100+ customers daily, recommending products based on consumer preferences through active listening and product knowledge, creating a personalized shopping experience that encouraged purchases and increased customer retention by 9%
- Focused on chocolate and licorice products while contributing to an 18% increase in sales through free samples and a catered customer experience, identified and eliminated low-margin products, reducing associated costs by 4% and improving profitability

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Phi Delta Theta

Pittsburgh, PA

Greek Sing - Head Crew Coordinator

Feb 2026 – Present

- Led 15 crew members in building and managing 11 individual stage backdrops for Shrek the musical with 60+ stage members
- Orchestrated rapid live set transitions within 5-10 seconds across 6 separate scenes, mapping placement and movement logistics through 3 full run-throughs to ensure each transition could be executed reliably ahead of a live performance for a 500+ audience
- Adapted movement strategy in real time when a narrower-than-anticipated sets ramp changed the pre-planned path, reassigning crew positioning and adjusting set movement to achieve 0 missed transitions or set breakdowns and earn 3rd in the competition

Investment Banking Academy

Pittsburgh, PA

Mentee

Jan 2026 – Present

- Student-run organization dedicated to guiding students in their pursuit of potential careers in the investment banking industry
- Selected from a competitive pool of 50+ undergraduate students after completing a rigorous interview process modeled after the process that most investment banks use for internship interviews, getting direct exposure to industry recruiting expectations
- Attended weekly workshops covering accounting, financial statement analysis, and common valuation methodologies, completed basic DCF and merger models, and worked with mentors to develop technical and behavioral skills through interview preparation

Tartan Student Fund

Pittsburgh, PA

Equity Research Analyst - TMT Team

Jan 2026 – Present

- Pitched long only investments in the TMT sector to CMU's student-managed investment fund that oversees \$180,000+ AUM
- Utilized public data, including SEC filings and research reports, to develop variant views on companies such as RDDT and FORM, identifying specific growth factors through the use of public comparable models, DCF analysis, and fundamental research
- Conducted weekly coverage of 5 TMT stocks to remain current on industry developments and individual fund holdings, tracking earnings, catalysts, and valuation changes to determine an appropriate time to sell, hold, or buy the corresponding positions

Introductory Finance Society

Pittsburgh, PA

Analyst

Sep 2025 – Dec 2025

- Participated and led in weekly groups throughout the fall semester to understand the fundamental concepts of high finance
- Demonstrated real-world knowledge through concepts including constructing a DCF from scratch and recommending a long position in RCLB with 24% upside, supported by multiple valuation methods and extensive company-specific financial research
- Networked with and gained understanding from professionals and upperclassmen across all industries of finance including investment banking, private equity, and hedge funds while developing industry insights and building valuable connections

INTERESTS

Interests: Baseball Cards, Dystopian Movies, Lacrosse, Ohio State Buckeyes, Spike Ball, Euchre, Pickleball, Fantasy Football